Methodology for implementing the NAWODHAN

1. Identification of Land (PSUs, Government land, private land)

Objective: Identify suitable land for project implementation

Process:

- Issue Expression of Interest (EoI) for land acquisition
- Evaluate responses based on technical and financial criteria
- Select suitable land for project implementation

2. Identification of Commercial Farmers through EoI

Objective: Identify commercial farmers for project partnership

Process:

- Issue EoI for commercial farmers to partner with the project
- Evaluate responses based on technical and financial criteria
- Select suitable commercial farmers for project partnership

3.Tender Procedure: QCBS (60:40)

Objective: Select suitable Farmers for project implementation

Process:

- Issue tender notice for project implementation
- Evaluate bids based on Quality-cum Cost Based Selection (QCBS) criteria
- Select suitable contractors for project implementation

4. Matchmaking

Objective: Match farmers with suitable land and resources

Process:

- Analyze farmer profiles and land availability
- Match farmers with suitable land and resources
- Facilitate partnership agreements between farmers and landowners

5. Option for Integration of RIAS in Government & PSU Land

Objective: Integrate Rural Integrated Agricultural Services (RIAS) in government and PSU lands

Process:

- Conduct feasibility study for RIAS integration
- Evaluate facilities and infrastructure requirements

- Develop plan for RIAS integration in government and PSU lands

6. Service Level Agreement

Objective: Establish clear service level agreements with project partners

Process:

- As per standard service level agreement format
- Negotiate agreement terms with project partners
- Sign service level agreements with project partners

7. Listing Crop Spectrum based on AEZ

Objective: Identify suitable crops for project implementation based on Agricultural Eco-Zones (AEZ)

Process:

- Analyse AEZ data and climate conditions
- Identify suitable crops for project implementation
- Develop crop spectrum list based on AEZ

8. Technical Support through NAWO-DHAN

Objective: Provide technical support to project partners through NAWO-DHAN

Process:

- Identify technical support requirements for project partners
- Develop plan for technical support delivery
- Provide technical support through NAWO-DHAN enablers and accelerators

9. Technical Support Enablers and Accelerators

Objective: Leverage various scheme supports, credits from financial institutions, and other enablers and accelerators for project implementation

Process:

- Identify available scheme supports and credits from financial institutions
- Develop plan for leveraging enablers and accelerators
- Facilitate access to enablers and accelerators for project partners

10. Information regarding Crop Insurance Scheme and Process for Filing Application

Objective: Provide information on crop insurance schemes and guide the process for filing applications

Process:

- Identify available crop insurance schemes
- Develop informational materials on the benefits and coverage of each scheme
- Guide project partners through the application process, including necessary documentation and deadlines
- Provide ongoing support for claims and renewals

11. Capacity Building Programme for Developing Proposals/Business Plans

Objective: Enhance the capacity of project partners to develop effective proposals and business plans

Process:

- Assess the current skill levels and training needs of project partners
- Develop a comprehensive training programme covering proposal writing, business plan development, and financial planning
- Conduct workshops, seminars, and one-on-one mentoring sessions
- Provide templates and tools to assist in the development of proposals and business plans
- Offer feedback and support throughout the proposal/business plan development process

NAWODHAN initiative aims to support farmers, youth, and Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs) through facilitating digital solutions. These solutions include providing access to real-time agricultural data, offering online training and resources, and facilitating digital marketplaces for better price discovery, logistic and infrastructure facilitation. By leveraging these digital tools, NAWODHAN seeks to improve productivity, sustainability, and overall economic well-being of the agricultural community.

Logistic & Infrastructure mapping

The available infrastructure facilities, including collection centers, warehouses, cold storages, pack houses, and processing units, play a crucial role in supporting agriculture and food processing. APEDA facilities further aid export-oriented businesses. By mapping logistics and infrastructure, we identify collaboration opportunities and gaps, facilitating investment and the growth of agro-processing clusters. Existing MSMEs and large food parks in Kerala are mapped for potential collaborations. Enabling infrastructures like roadways, ports, railways, and airports support seamless logistics. Additionally, information on subsidies and assistance from GoI and GoK schemes is available to bolster these efforts.

KABCO will map large agro-processing clusters, food parks, and existing food processing units in Kerala to establish forward linkages, fostering growth in the agriculture and food processing sectors. This initiative will attract investment, drive innovation, and enhance competitiveness by identifying clusters based on crop specialization and market demand. The mapping exercise will identify infrastructure gaps and facilitate investment, supporting the development of critical infrastructure and services.

KABCO will also identify existing food processing MSMEs for potential collaborations and target large food parks for strategic partnerships. Enabling infrastructures like roadways, ports, railways, and airports will support seamless logistics. Additionally, KABCO will provide information on subsidies and assistance from Government of India (GoI) and Government of Kerala (GoK) schemes, contributing to the overall economic development of Kerala.

Monitoring, Evaluation & Risk Management

Comprehensive Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) Framework for NAWODHAN Project

KABCO will establish a comprehensive Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) framework to track the NAWODHAN project's progress, assess its impact, and identify areas for improvement across the entire agricultural value chain.

Data Collection and Management

KABCO will establish robust data collection mechanisms, gathering baseline data and continuously collecting data on crop growth, yield, quality, and market performance. Digital tools and technologies like mobile apps, IoT sensors, and data analytics platforms will be leveraged to collect and manage data efficiently.

Evaluation Criteria

The M&E framework will define clear evaluation criteria aligned with project objectives, including metrics on productivity, quality standards, financial performance, and socio-economic impact. These criteria will assess the effectiveness of strategies and interventions, ensuring they contribute to desired outcomes.

Periodic Reviews

Regular reviews will be conducted to evaluate project progress, involving stakeholders at all levels, including farmers, FPOs, government officials, and international partners. Review meetings will guide adjustments to the project plan and implementation strategies, ensuring the project remains on track to achieve its goals.

II. Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) for NAWODHAN Project

KABCO will identify and monitor specific Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) that reflect the project's performance and impact. These KPIs will be regularly tracked and reported to ensure that the project is meeting its targets and objectives. Such as

- Crop Yield
- Quality Standards
- Export Volumes
- Financial Performance
- Socio-Economic Impact

III. Continuous Improvement through Regular Reporting and Feedback

Regular reporting and feedback mechanisms are critical for maintaining transparency, accountability, and continuous improvement in the NAWODHAN project. KABCO will implement a structured process for generating and disseminating reports, as well as collecting and acting on feedback from stakeholders.

Monthly and Quarterly Reports

KABCO will produce detailed reports to track project progress, performance, and KPIs, enabling prompt identification of trends and issues.

Stakeholder Meetings

Regular meetings with stakeholders will facilitate discussion of progress, challenges, and feedback, ensuring the project remains responsive to their needs.

Feedback Collection

KABCO will collect feedback from participants through various channels to identify strengths and areas for improvement, guiding future actions.

Continuous Improvement Initiatives

Insights from reports and feedback will drive initiatives to refine farming practices, enhance support services, and adopt new technologies, ensuring sustained success and impact.

Grievance Redressal Mechanism

For NAWODHAN implementation

To ensure transparency, accountability, and prompt resolution of grievances, the Kerala Agro Business Company has established a comprehensive Grievance Redressal Mechanism. This mechanism is designed to address the concerns of all stakeholders, including farmers, employees, and partners, in a fair and efficient manner. Stakeholders can submit their grievances through the following channels:

Phone: Can call the dedicated grievance helpline at +91 1234567890, 0471 4601888

Email: Can send the complaint through email to kabcoamd@gmail.com, kabco.info@gmail.com

Apart from the above options, if it is felt necessary by the complainant to send the communication in physical form, the same may be sent to KABCO addressed to:

Additional Managing Director

Kerala Agro Business Company Limited (KABCO)

Third Floor - Trans Tower, Vazhuthacaud

Thiruvananthapuram - 695014, Kerala

Dispute Resolution on Service Level Agreement

- The district collector is recognised as the chief pattern of this arrangement to enhance agricultural output. and the Principal Agriculture Officer shall be the patron of this arrangement.
- Any disputes arising out of or in connection with this Agreement shall be resolved amicably through mutual discussions.
- If the parties are unable to resolve the dispute amicably, the dispute shall be referred to arbitration in accordance with the Arbitration and Conciliation Act, 1996.
- The venue of arbitration shall be [City], and the language of arbitration shall be Malayalam/English.
- Arbitrational Tribunal shall consist of three members and the chief arbitrator shall be a retired judicial officer of the rank of a Judicial Magistrate or Munsiff or higher. The other two members shall be retired agricultural officers (or higher rank).
- The tribunal shall accord priority in awarding timely interim measures invoking powers under section 17 of the Arbitration and Conciliation Act, 1996 after assessing the possibility of either party suffering irrecoverable damage or gauging the scale of convenience.

I. Identification of Potential Risks

To ensure the success and sustainability of the NAWODHAN project, it is essential to identify and understand the potential risks that could impact the project. These risks can be broadly categorised into climatic conditions, market fluctuations, and operational challenges.

Climatic Conditions

Agricultural activities are highly susceptible to climatic variations, leading to adverse effects on crop growth, yield, and quality, and resulting in significant financial losses. Climate change poses long-term risks by altering weather patterns and increasing the frequency of extreme weather events.

Market Fluctuations

The agricultural market is inherently volatile, with prices subject to fluctuations due to factors such as supply and demand dynamics, changes in consumer preferences, and global economic conditions. Sudden drops in market prices or demand can impact the profitability of the produce, making risk management crucial.

Operational Challenges

Operational risks encompass logistical challenges, supply chain disruptions, pest and disease outbreaks, and labour shortages, which can impact smooth operations and produce quality. Efficiently managing these risks is essential to maintain consistency and quality of the produce.

II. Risk Mitigation Strategies

To mitigate the identified risks, KABCO will implement a comprehensive set of strategies designed to minimise the impact of adverse events and ensure the project's resilience

Diversification of Crops

KABCO will advise the crop portfolio to reduce risk by cultivating a variety of high-value crops, hedging against the failure of any single crop due to climatic conditions or market fluctuations. This diversification spreads the risk, ensuring a more stable income for farmers and FPOs.

Insurance Schemes

KABCO will facilitate access to agricultural insurance schemes to protect participants against financial losses caused by climatic events, pest outbreaks, and other unforeseen challenges. These insurance schemes will cover crop loss and damage, providing a safety net for farmers and ensuring their financial stability.

Contingency Planning

KABCO will establish contingency plans for various scenarios, such as market crashes, and logistic disruptions, outlining specific actions, resources, and roles to be taken in case of emergencies. Regular drills and training sessions will be conducted to ensure all stakeholders are familiar with the plans and can act swiftly when needed.

III. Establishment of Risk Management Committee

To systematically address and manage risks, KABCO will establish a dedicated Risk Management Committee. This committee will oversee the implementation of risk mitigation strategies and ensure that emerging risks are promptly identified and addressed.

Impact & Conclusion

Through NAWODHAN project can positively impact farmers in several ways:

Increased Income: Direct financial support, subsidies, or improved pricing mechanisms can boost farmers' income and economic stability.

Enhanced Production & Productivity: Access to advanced technology, better seeds, or modern farming practices can lead to higher crop yields and more efficient farming operations.

Improved Resource Access: Schemes that provide grants or low-cost inputs (like fertilizers and irrigation systems) can reduce production costs and improve farm outputs.

Training and Education: Programs that offer training in best practices, pest management, and sustainable techniques can enhance farmers' skills and knowledge.

Risk Mitigation: Support such as crop insurance or disaster relief can protect farmers from financial losses due to unexpected events like droughts or floods.

Better Market Access: Improved infrastructure or support for cooperatives can enhance farmers' access to markets, leading to better prices for their products.

Sustainable Practices: Encouragement of environmentally friendly practices can lead to long-term benefits for the soil and overall farm health, ensuring future productivity.

Conclusion

The NAWO-DHAN project is a significant milestone aimed at utilizing available land and resources on identified fallow lands to generate sustainable income by increasing production. This pilot project can be replicated on other unutilized public lands to benefit the farming community. By offering attractive packages, the project can attract the younger generation to farming, with agricultural start-ups playing a crucial role in building Kerala’s future through this innovative approach.

Elevating domestic food quality standards in Kerala, the NAWODHAN project will implement rigorous cultivation practices and meet international quality requirements to ensure premium produce. Even the “rejects” that do not meet export criteria will be of higher quality and safer than conventional standards, benefiting local consumers with access to high-quality, safe, and nutritious food. This improvement in food quality will enhance public health outcomes and raise consumer expectations. The project’s focus on sustainability and risk management will ensure lasting benefits, with KABCO aiming to transform Kerala's agricultural landscape through a scalable model.

Looking ahead, the NAWODHAN project is set to revolutionize Kerala's agricultural sector by selecting 15,445 units of unutilized land, each spanning 10 acres, to significantly increase the production of vegetables and fruits to 12.35 lakh metric tons annually. This boost in production will not only achieve self-sufficiency in vegetable and fruit supply but also raise farmers' incomes to an impressive ₹3,705 crore per year. The project will create 25,000 man-days of employment annually, providing substantial job opportunities. Additionally, the government is projected to earn an average of ₹46.34 crore per year in service charges. These outcomes underscore a promising future for Kerala's agricultural sector, marked by economic growth, improved farmer livelihoods, and sustainable development.